

Daily Bible Note

Date: June 14, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Corinthians 15:20-28

20 But now Christ is risen from the dead, and has become the firstfruits of those who have fallen asleep.

21 For since by man came death, by Man also came the resurrection of the dead.

22 For as in Adam all die, even so in Christ all shall be made alive.

23 But each one in his own order: Christ the firstfruits, afterward those who are Christ's at His coming.

24 Then comes the end, when He delivers the kingdom to God the Father, when He puts an end to all rule and all authority and power.

25 For He must reign till He has put all enemies under His feet.

26 The last enemy that will be destroyed is death.

27 For "He has put all things under His feet." But when He says "all things are put under Him," it is evident that He who put all things under Him is excepted.

28 Now when all things are made subject to Him, then the Son Himself will also be subject to Him who put all things under Him, that God may be all in all.

II. Key Summary

- Paul declares that Christ has been raised from the dead, calling Him "the firstfruits of those who have fallen asleep," and draws a parallel between Adam who brought death and Christ who brings resurrection (vv. 20-22).
- Paul describes resurrection as happening in a fixed order: Christ first, then those who belong to Christ at His coming, then the end when Christ destroys all rule and authority and delivers the kingdom to God the Father (vv. 23-24).
- Paul states that "the last enemy that will be destroyed is death," concluding with the

Son subjecting Himself to the Father so that God may be all in all (vv. 26-28).

III. Passage Analysis

The Firstfruits — One Man's Resurrection, a Promise for Everyone

"The firstfruits were the first ripe corn of the harvest, which by Jewish law were presented as an earnest of the mighty harvest hereafter." [1]

In Jewish practice, a farmer brought the very first grain of the harvest to the temple — not because the whole harvest was done, but because the harvest was guaranteed. Paul uses this image to say: Christ's resurrection is not just His own exit from death. It is the announcement that everyone who belongs to Him will follow. He went first; we come after.

Death Is a Defeated Enemy

"Death is a defeated enemy because of Jesus; for believers, 'your labor is not in vain in the Lord' — knowing we will rise should make us steadfast and immovable in service right now." [2]

Verse 26 is plain: "The last enemy that will be destroyed is death." Death has always been humanity's deepest fear. But Paul is saying this enemy has already been sentenced — the verdict is in, even if the execution isn't complete yet. Because the ending is fixed, everything we do for God now actually means something and will not disappear.

IV. Reflection Question

Is there something in your life that feels completely over — like there's no coming back from it?

Paul says even death is just the last enemy to be destroyed — and Christ already walked out of it first, a guarantee for everyone who belongs to Him.

References

[1] BibleHub.com, Cambridge Bible for Schools and Colleges,
https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/1_corinthians/15-20.htm

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik Commentary,
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-corinthians-15/>